Static Object Labelling for Verification: From Semantic Categories and Property-Tag Ideation to JSOLV and ClangSOLV

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Abstract

An ordinary type identifies the kind of a program value, but rarely records whether that value has been persisted, validated, authenticated, reconciled, or processed through another required workflow. Encoding every combination of these independent facts as a nominal type can obscure the domain model and complicate otherwise ordinary APIs. This paper develops an alternative: application-owned symbolic labels, checked as a flow-sensitive layer over ordinary types. It unifies two prior lines of ideation—explicit semantic categories for legible programming languages, and user-defined static property tags—with two implemented tools. JSOLV generates Java annotations from a small configuration and checks their contracts during javac processing. ClangSOLV generates C++ label declarations and uses a standalone Clang LibTooling frontend to check contracts before native compilation. Both tools use independent positive facts, subset requirements, intersection at joins, and a single-input preservation contract that composes arbitrary label sets. ClangSOLV additionally implements conservative effect invalidation, structured loop analysis, explicit proof markers, and pointee labels for standard smart pointers. We present the motivating philosophy, a common mathematical model, complete application examples, build integration, diagnostics, implementation differences, trust assumptions, regression evidence, and a research agenda. The paper separates implemented contract-flow checking from broader proposed features such as negative facts, contextual tags, verified postconditions and heap-sensitive reasoning. Neither implementation is claimed to prove domain predicates or arbitrary program correctness. Their practical contribution is to make selected semantic obligations visible and mechanically checkable without changing the application's ordinary object representation.

Contents

1 Introduction: what an ordinary type leaves unsaid **4**
1.1 Contributions and boundaries 4

2 Semantic categories and codebase legibility **4**
2.1 The many architectural meanings of a class 4
2.2 Ontology and epistemology 5
2.3 Independent facts and nominal proliferation 5

3 From property-tag ideation to a deliberately small core **6**
3.1 The broad proposal 6
3.2 Implemented positive evidence 6
3.3 Why vocabulary and behavior belong in different places 7

4 Common mathematical model **7**
4.1 Label identity and environments . . . 7
4.2 Requirements, fresh values and assignment . . . 7
4.3 Call contracts and preservation . . . 8
4.4 Joins and short-circuit evaluation . . . 8
4.5 A small compositional argument . . . 8
4.6 Complexity and termination . . . 8

5 A running publishing example **9**

6 JSOLV: architecture and configurable annotations **9**
6.1 Components and naming . . . 9
6.2 The marker protocol . . . 9
6.3 Generation before checking . . . 10

7 A complete Java application **10**
7.1 Rejected calls and local obligations . . . 11
7.2 Preservation from another argument . . . 12
7.3 Branches . . . 12

8 Java build setup and separate compilation **12**

9 How JSOLV checks Java source **13**

10 ClangSOLV: a standalone C++ checking frontend **14**
10.1 Why a frontend rather than only a template library . . . 14
10.2 Configuration and generated label types . . . 14
10.3 Readable public contracts . . . 14

11 A complete C++ application **15**
11.1 Rejected uses . . . 16
11.2 Explicit markers . . . 16

12 C++ effects, aliases and structured flow **17**
12.1 Invalidation as the conservative default . . . 17
12.2 Loops and reachable exits . . . 17
12.3 Unsupported syntax and evaluation order . . . 17

13 Smart pointers: labels belong to the pointee **18**
13.1 The semantic choice . . . 18
13.2 Copies, moves and dereferencing . . . 18
13.3 Snapshot evidence instead of a heap graph . . . 19
13.4 Ownership and lifetime boundaries . . . 19

14 C++ build integration and reproducible use **19**

15 Diagnostics, reports and auditability **20**
15.1 A common diagnostic contract . . . 20
15.2 JSOLV schema . . . 20
15.3 ClangSOLV schema . . . 21

16 What the two implementations have in common, and what they do not **21**

17 Trust, conditional soundness and failure modes **22**
17.1 Where evidence enters . . . 22
17.2 A conditional property, not a whole-program theorem . . . 22
17.3 Typical false confidence . . . 23
17.4 False positives and appropriate remedies . . . 23

18 Application areas and vocabulary design **23**
18.1 Input processing and security workflows . . . 23
18.2 Numerical and scientific workflows . . . 23
18.3 Financial and operational workflows . . . 23
18.4 Protocol milestones and capabilities . . . 24
18.5 Vocabulary governance . . . 24

19 Relationship to other approaches **24**
19.1 Wrappers and phantom types . . . 24
19.2 Refinement types and dependent types . . . 24
19.3 Typestate, taint and effects . . . 24
19.4 Qualifier frameworks and abstract interpretation . . . 24

20 Regression evidence and evaluation limits **25**

21 Adoption in an existing application **25**

22 A research agenda grounded in the implementations **25**
22.1 Negative knowledge . . . 25
22.2 Contextual labels and implication . . . 26
22.3 Verified producers and predicate refinement . . . 26
22.4 Precision in effects and heap state . . . 26
22.5 Control flow, provenance and concurrency . . . 26
22.6 Empirical questions . . . 26

23 Conclusion **26**

A Repository map and document provenance **27**

B Compact contract-writing checklist **27**

1 Introduction: what an ordinary type leaves unsaid

A publishing function can accept an `Article`, a payment function a `Payment`, and a numerical routine a `Matrix`. These types answer important questions about representation and permitted operations. They do not normally say whether this particular article was persisted, this payment authorised, or this matrix checked for positive definiteness. Those facts often determine whether a call is meaningful even when every conventional type check succeeds.

Programmers compensate using names, comments, runtime checks, wrapper types, and informal sequencing rules. A function named `publishValidated` signals an intention but cannot by its name prevent an unvalidated argument. A runtime assertion may catch a violation, but only during an execution that reaches it. A wrapper such as `ValidatedArticle` can enforce a useful construction boundary, but many independent facts produce pressure for many wrapper combinations and conversions.

The approach studied here retains ordinary domain types while adding a separate layer of static knowledge. A value can simultaneously have `Persisted`, `Validated`, and `Authenticated`, without becoming a new nominal kind of article. A consumer lists the facts it needs; producer contracts describe what their results establish; a checker follows the supported value flow and rejects a use lacking required evidence.

This is a synthesis of four local research artifacts. The first argues that mainstream syntax should reveal materially different semantic roles rather than encode them all as classes [1]. The second proposes a general static property-tag layer [2]. Two subsequent papers document Java and C++ implementations [3, 4]. Their central arguments and mechanisms are restated here: no earlier paper is required to understand the system or reproduce the examples.

1.1 Contributions and boundaries

The paper contributes a unified account of five design choices:

1. separate nominal type identity from transient, correctness-relevant facts;
2. let application teams declare their vocabulary without editing analyzers;
3. keep behavioral contracts beside function signatures, rather than in a second configuration language;
4. compose labels through a small set algebra and explicit preservation;
5. distinguish checked evidence transport from trusted domain semantics.

It also explains why Java and C++ require different engineering compromises. JSOLV uses native annotation syntax and Maven generation. ClangSOLV uses declaration macros and a separate compiler-like executable, including a bounded smart-pointer model. The portable template-based CSOLV alternative is discussed for context, but this paper's implemented subjects are JSOLV and ClangSOLV.

"Verification" here means checking that a requirement follows from the tool's supported propagation rules and supplied summaries. It does not mean proving that a database commit occurred, a validator is correct, a credential is authentic, or a mutable object cannot change elsewhere. A precise account of these limits is part of the design, not an optional qualification.

2 Semantic categories and codebase legibility

2.1 The many architectural meanings of a class

Classes in mainstream codebases serve several roles: passive compound data, encapsulated mutable objects, namespace-like collections of static functions, service facades, callback objects, policy objects, and wrappers introduced solely to encode a static condition. Their common syntax is flexible, but a reader must often reconstruct the intended role from member patterns, constructors, naming conventions, or documentation.

The earlier semantic-category proposal argues for exposing stable distinctions when they improve understanding and enable meaningful restrictions. A record primarily groups data. A stateful object emphasizes identity and invariants. A module groups declarations without per-instance identity. A callable emphasizes behavior as a value. A property declaration records knowledge orthogonal to a nominal type. These categories need not require a new language all at once; the argument provides a criterion for evaluating their usefulness.

Role	Information made explicit	Possible enforcement benefit
Record	Data composition	Restricted inheritance and generated structural operations
Stateful object	Identity and hidden invariants	Controlled mutation through an interface
Module	Grouping without instances	No accidental per-instance state
Callable	Behavior and captured context	Explicit capture and invocation rules
Static property	Knowledge about a current value	Required evidence at designated uses

Table 1: Semantic categories motivating the property-label design. These are conceptual roles, not new declaration kinds implemented by the present tools.

Naming conventions help but are advisory and locally variable. An explicit language or tooling category can provide a reliable signal to code browsers, reviewers and analyzers, and can narrow the legal design space. The benefit is especially visible under incomplete familiarity: a maintainer entering a large repository must learn its architecture without reading it linearly.

The philosophy does not require replacing every class. A new category is worth introducing when its role is frequent, readers benefit from seeing it, tools can enforce useful restrictions, and the construct removes more boilerplate than conceptual overhead. The present work applies that threshold to semantic properties using existing language extension points.

2.2 Ontology and epistemology

The distinction can be expressed as

$$x : T \qquad \text{versus} \qquad x : T \, \{P_1, \ldots, P_k\}.$$

The first judgment describes what the value is. The second also describes what is known about it at a program point. An article remains an article after validation; knowledge of its validity changes. Conversely, a domain type such as `AccountId` may deserve nominal identity regardless of whether its current value has been checked against an account registry.

This distinction also guides API design. A new nominal type is appropriate when it represents a domain concept, a distinct operation set, or an encapsulation boundary. A label is appropriate when the same representation and operations remain useful while selected consumers demand additional facts. Neither mechanism eliminates the other.

2.3 Independent facts and nominal proliferation

With n independent Boolean conditions, up to 2^n combinations are conceptually possible. This does not imply that a wrapper-based program must declare 2^n classes: generic wrappers and phantom types can encode combinations compactly. It does explain why naming every useful combination is unattractive. Labels instead represent combinations as sets and keep ordinary APIs usable.

Representation benefits must also be stated carefully. A label layer avoids introducing a new runtime wrapper representation, but wrapper types do not necessarily allocate or have measurable runtime overhead. Their principal tradeoff here is a change to API types and composition, not a universal performance penalty.

3 From property-tag ideation to a deliberately small core

3.1 The broad proposal

The ideation paper treats user-defined tags as atomic propositions over program values. It proposes introduction at proof points, requirements at consumers, invalidation on changes, and interprocedural summaries. It also considers definite negative information, predicate-sensitive branches, parameterized properties, implication hierarchies, linear capabilities, scoped facts, proof tokens, and interaction with ownership and concurrency.

The central value-centric intuition is that a fact belongs to the current value or object state, not permanently to an identifier. After `x = readOtherValue()`, evidence for the old value does not certify the replacement. In SSA terminology, the two assignments bind different value versions. For mutable heap objects, the analogous distinction requires reasoning about object state and aliases, not merely variable names.

3.2 Implemented positive evidence

Both implementations select a smaller fragment: finite sets of independent, positive, uninterpreted labels. A missing label means *not established by this analysis*, not *proved false*. There is no built-in implication from `Authenticated` to `Validated`, and no negative requirement such as `!Confidential`.

This fragment avoids a logical solver and keeps configuration limited to names. Even a small core offers a useful workflow guarantee: supported call sites cannot pass values to designated consumers without evidence for every listed prerequisite. More ambitious features require new semantics and tests; they are not implied by the vocabulary's extensibility.

Idea	Status in the implemented systems
Application-defined positive labels	Implemented in both
Requirements and trusted return facts	Implemented in both
Single-input, all-label preservation	Implemented in both
Branch and conditional intersection	Implemented in both
Loop fixed points and reachability	Structured subset in ClangSOLV; restricted handling in JSOLV
Explicit establish/require/forget markers	Implemented in ClangSOLV
Conservative mutation and effect kills	Implemented in ClangSOLV; not general JSOLV effect analysis
Smart-pointer pointee evidence	Implemented bounded subset in ClangSOLV
Negative facts and refutation	Proposed only
Predicate-dependent validation contracts	Proposed only
Context parameters and implication rules	Proposed only
Linear labels and scoped capabilities	Proposed only
Verified postconditions and proof tokens	Proposed only
Precise heap identity and concurrent state	Future work

Idea	Status in the implemented systems

Table 2: The distinction between ideation and delivered behavior.

3.3 Why vocabulary and behavior belong in different places

A properties file declares names such as `Persisted` and `Approved`. Function declarations express behavior. This division avoids a second language of method selectors, wildcard matching, precedence rules and external contracts that can drift away from code. Extending the vocabulary remains a simple application task, while establishing or preserving a property remains a visible API responsibility.

The configuration does not define the truth of a label. An application must document what `Persisted` means: inserted in a local store, committed durably, acknowledged by a remote service, or something else. The analyzer only transports the corresponding symbol.

4 Common mathematical model

4.1 Label identity and environments

Let $\mathcal{L}$ be the finite label vocabulary relevant to a compilation. Labels have qualified identities; two labels with the same short spelling in different packages or namespaces are distinct. An environment maps tracked compiler symbols to sets:

$$\Gamma : V \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(\mathcal{L}).$$

An absent binding is equivalent to the empty set. The symbol identity comes from the compiler, so shadowed variables with identical spelling do not share evidence.

Expression evaluation computes an evidence set and, where effects are modeled, an updated environment:

$$\mathcal{E}(e, \Gamma) = (S, \Gamma').$$

This formulation matters for C++: checking an argument and then invoking an impure function can consume incoming evidence while erasing other facts. JSOLV implements a less effect-sensitive variant of the same positive-set idea.

4.2 Requirements, fresh values and assignment

For a consumer requiring R, with available evidence S,

$$\text{accept}(R, S) \iff R \subseteq S, \qquad \text{missing}(R, S) = R \setminus S.$$

A fresh ordinary value supplies no labels unless a supported producer contract or explicit trusted introduction supplies them. Binding a variable records the right-hand side's evidence. It does not union the old binding's labels with the new value's labels.

JSOLV usually replaces just the assigned variable's set. ClangSOLV erases the environment on a write before installing any fresh result evidence on a supported destination. The latter rule can lose unrelated facts, but prevents modeled aliases from retaining old evidence across a write.

4.3 Call contracts and preservation

Represent a function summary by requirements $R_1, \ldots, R_m$, declared result labels A, and an optional preserved input index k. For incoming argument sets $S_1, \ldots, S_m$, the call requires $R_i \subseteq S_i$ and yields

$$S_{\text{result}} = \begin{cases} A \cup S_k, & \text{if preservation is declared,} \\ A, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Indices count explicit arguments from one. Java's `@PreservesTags` defaults to one; C++'s `preserves()` does the same.

Preservation is label-polymorphic: a validator does not need to list every label an application may someday add. It promises to retain all facts known on the selected input. The promise concerns the result's properties, not object identity. Returning the same mutable object is insufficient if the operation invalidates an input property.

Only one input is selected. Unioning facts from unrelated inputs onto one output is not generally justified. An authenticated user and a persisted article do not automatically make an authenticated article; that relationship needs a truthful domain-specific contract.

4.4 Joins and short-circuit evaluation

Facts survive an alternative only when guaranteed on every relevant incoming path:

$$(\Gamma_1 \sqcap \Gamma_2)(v) = \Gamma_1(v) \cap \Gamma_2(v).$$

Conditional expression evidence is likewise the intersection of alternative results. Short-circuit evaluation joins the path that skips the right operand with the path that executes it. Union would be incorrect: a label established on just one branch cannot justify a consumer after the merge.

The two implementations disagree about which paths are considered reachable. ClangSOLV ends normal flow at supported returns and throws, and propagates break and continue separately. JSOLV's current scanner does not generally prune those exits. The set rule is shared; the control-flow approximation is not.

4.5 A small compositional argument

Proposition 1 (Preservation composition)**.** *Suppose three successful producer calls declare result sets A, B, C. If the second preserves the first result's evidence and the third preserves the second's, then the final result carries $A \cup B \cup C$ under the supported call rules.*

Proof. The second call yields $B \cup A$. The third yields $C \cup (B \cup A) = A \cup B \cup C$. No implication between labels or enumeration of combinations is required. □

This is a statement about evidence propagation, not semantic truth of the three domain operations. It is useful precisely because the analyzer need not interpret the labels to check composition.

4.6 Complexity and termination

With n labels and m tracked symbols, a conceptual bit-set representation needs $O(mn)$ bits. Set inclusion, intersection and union are finite operations. The actual prototypes use ordinary sets of qualified strings rather than a specialized bit-vector implementation. No measured timing claim follows from the algebra alone.

A finite domain makes fixed-point analysis feasible, but does not by itself prove termination of every arbitrary implementation: transfer monotonicity, iteration order and auxiliary state also matter. ClangSOLV uses descending structured-loop iterations with a 1024-pass safety limit. A future general worklist engine should state and test its convergence assumptions explicitly.

5 A running publishing example

Let an article pass through three stages. Persistence establishes `Persisted`; validation establishes `Validated` while retaining existing facts; authentication establishes `Authenticated` while retaining them. Publication demands all three.

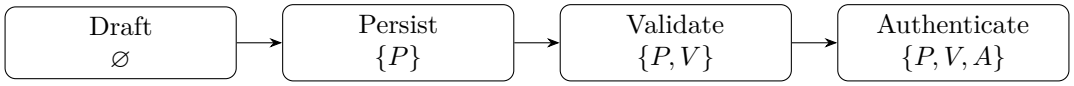


Figure 1: Ordinary domain objects with accumulating evidence. Publication requires the final set; the letters abbreviate the three independent labels.

The example concerns an application's chosen authentication guarantee. It does not prescribe a security protocol. In particular, a Boolean label cannot encode a principal, article version, expiry time and policy automatically. An application may place that context in immutable domain data or use a more explicit label such as `DemoAuthorAuthenticated`; parametric labels remain future work.

6 JSOLV: architecture and configurable annotations

6.1 Components and naming

JSOLV expands to *Java Static Object Labelling for Verification*. The repository contains a Maven reactor with annotations, checker, generator plugin and demo modules, plus an independently built application. The shared support package is `org.jsolv`; the processor is `org.jsolv.checker.JsolvProcessor`. Version `1.0-SNAPSHOT` denotes local development artifacts, not an assertion of Maven Central publication.

An application vocabulary is configured as follows:

```
# jsolv.properties, beside the application's pom.xml
package=example.tags
labels=Persisted, Validated, Authenticated, Approved
```

The UTF-8 Java-properties format supports comments and continuations. Exactly two keys are accepted. Missing keys, unknown keys, duplicates, invalid identifiers, keywords and malformed label lists fail generation. Application programmers add a name and rebuild; no checker registry changes.

6.2 The marker protocol

Each generated annotation has the following shape:

```
package example.tags;

@org.jsolv.StaticTag
@java.lang.annotation.Retention(
    java.lang.annotation.RetentionPolicy.CLASS)
@java.lang.annotation.Target({
    java.lang.annotation.ElementType.TYPE_USE,
    java.lang.annotation.ElementType.PARAMETER,
    java.lang.annotation.ElementType.METHOD})
public @interface Validated {}
```

The Java language provides annotation declarations and their use sites [5]; JSOLV assigns the custom flow semantics. Recognition depends on the `@StaticTag` meta-annotation, not a package

naming convention. Support annotation names are fully qualified in generated files, avoiding collisions when an application chooses a label named `Target`.

CLASS retention permits contracts to be distributed in compiled libraries. METHOD targeting is deliberate: the checker reads method declaration metadata as well as return-type metadata, a practical route for ordinary return annotation placement across the tested JDK 17 compilation boundaries. This does not claim complete support for every possible nested type-use placement.

The preservation annotation is shared rather than generated per application:

```
@Target(ElementType.METHOD)
@Retention(RetentionPolicy.CLASS)
public @interface PreservesTags {
    int value() default 1;
}
```

Imports for `Target`, `Retention` and their enums are assumed in this support-definition excerpt.

6.3 Generation before checking

The Maven plugin's `generate` goal runs in `generate-sources`, before compilation in the lifecycle [7]. It registers a dedicated generated source root. javac consequently resolves generated annotations normally before the checker examines their uses.

Combining first-round generation and checking in one processor would introduce unresolved-import and processing-round complications. Separating vocabulary generation is simpler and makes failure behavior clearer. The generator validates before changing output, preserves unchanged timestamps, and removes obsolete owned generated sources without deleting an arbitrary directory. Handwritten files are not silently overwritten.

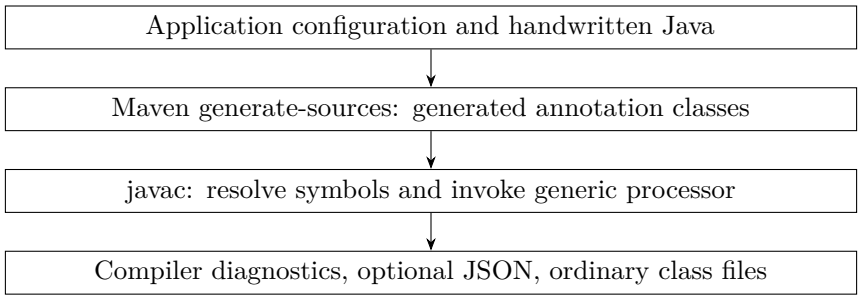


Figure 2: JSOLV's integration with the ordinary Java build.

7 A complete Java application

The following class assumes the generated `example.tags` vocabulary. The in-memory store and demo credential make domain behavior concrete without claiming durable persistence or production authentication.

```
import example.tags.*;
import org.jsolv.PreservesTags;
import java.util.ArrayList;
import java.util.List;

public final class PaperWorkflow {
    record Article(String title) {}
    private static final List<Article> STORE = new ArrayList<>();

    static @Persisted Article persist(Article article) {
        STORE.add(article);
        return article;
    }

    @PreservesTags
    static @Validated Article validate(Article article) {
        if (article.title() == null || article.title().isBlank())
            throw new IllegalArgumentException("empty title");
        return article;
    }

    @PreservesTags
    static @Authenticated Article authenticate(
            Article article, String credential) {
        if (!"demo-author".equals(credential))
            throw new IllegalArgumentException("bad demo credential");
        return article;
    }

    static void publish(
            @Persisted @Validated @Authenticated Article article) {
        System.out.println("Published: " + article.title());
    }

    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Article draft = new Article("One type, several facts");
        Article saved = persist(draft);
        Article checked = validate(saved);
        Article ready = authenticate(checked, "demo-author");
        publish(ready);
        publish(authenticate(validate(persist(draft)), "demo-author"));
    }
}
```

Each successful return is a trusted postcondition. A bug that removes the validation check does not automatically make JSOLV reject the method's `@Validated` declaration. The checker analyzes calls in the method, but does not verify its promised return predicates.

7.1 Rejected calls and local obligations

In the same class, these additional statements are rejected:

```
publish(draft);                          // no required evidence
publish(validate(persist(draft)));       // missing Authenticated
@Persisted Article forged = draft;      // local annotation is a requirement
publish((@Persisted Article) draft);     // cast does not introduce evidence
```

Local annotations impose requirements on their initializer and later assignments. They do not turn an assertion into a proof. An ordinary unannotated transformation supplies no result evidence even if its body returns its input, unless a preservation summary says otherwise.

7.2 Preservation from another argument

```
@PreservesTags(2)
static @Validated Article chooseSecond(Article ignored, Article article) {
    return validate(article);
}
```

The result retains facts from the second argument. Java validates the preservation index on source declarations: it must name a valid, non-varargs parameter and the return must be non-void. The current Java checker does not enforce the C++ implementation's same-domain-type preservation restriction. An application must therefore be particularly careful not to transfer unrelated predicates across types through an untruthful summary.

7.3 Branches

```
Article chosen;
if (args.length > 0) chosen = checked;
else chosen = saved;
@Persisted Article common = chosen;     // accepted
// @Validated Article tooStrong = chosen; // rejected
```

Only persistence is common to both assignments. A branch followed by an early return may still be conservatively included by JSOLV, because the current scanner does not model normal-path reachability fully.

8 Java build setup and separate compilation

Install the tools once, then compile the independent example:

```
mvn -f development_tools/jsolv/pom.xml clean install
mvn -f development_tools/jsolv-app/pom.xml clean compile
```

The tested baseline recorded by the Java artifact is JDK 17.0.12 and Maven 3.9.11. A JDK is required, including the compiler used by compilation tests. Teams can deploy the artifacts to their own repository so application programmers need not rebuild the tooling to add a label.

A consumer depends on the support annotations:

```
<dependency>
  <groupId>org.jsolv</groupId>
  <artifactId>jsolv-annotations</artifactId>
  <version>1.0-SNAPSHOT</version>
</dependency>
```

Within `build/plugins`, generation and checking are configured as follows:

```
<plugin>
  <groupId>org.jsolv</groupId>
  <artifactId>jsolv-maven-plugin</artifactId>
  <version>1.0-SNAPSHOT</version>
  <executions>
    <execution><goals><goal>generate</goal></goals></execution>
  </executions>
</plugin>
<plugin>
  <groupId>org.apache.maven.plugins</groupId>
  <artifactId>maven-compiler-plugin</artifactId>
  <version>3.13.0</version>
  <configuration>
    <release>17</release>
    <proc>full</proc>
    <annotationProcessorPaths>
      <path>
        <groupId>org.jsolv</groupId>
        <artifactId>jsolv-checker</artifactId>
        <version>1.0-SNAPSHOT</version>
      </path>
    </annotationProcessorPaths>
    <compilerArgs>
      <arg>-Ajsolv.report=${project.build.directory}/jsolv-report.json</arg>
    </compilerArgs>
  </configuration>
</plugin>
```

Explicit processing makes the build contract visible. The optional report argument can be omitted. The generator can be configured with a different `configFile` or `outputDirectory`; `-Djsolv.config=...` also selects a config file.

Use lifecycle commands such as `mvn compile`, rather than invoking `compiler:compile` directly and skipping generation. An IDE may need `mvn generate-sources` and a Maven reimport before resolving newly generated annotations. After deleting or renaming a label, use a clean build: removing its generated source need not remove an old compiled class file.

For several application modules, generate the vocabulary once in an application-owned labels JAR. Consumers depend on it and activate the checker; they need no duplicate configuration registry. Qualified identities, metadata retention and compilation-boundary tests support that deployment pattern.

9 How JSOLV checks Java source

The processor uses compiler trees and language-model elements through the JDK `Trees` bridge [6]. It recognizes all annotation types, selects those marked as static tags, and returns false from processing so other processors' annotations are not claimed.

Each method begins with its parameters' required label sets. Expression evaluation handles identifiers, assignments, casts, calls and conditional expressions, recursively checking nested calls and constructor arguments. Sets are copied as immutable binding evidence. Expanded varargs arguments are checked individually; array and component qualifier flow is not a general feature.

For loops, try statements and switches, potentially assigned variables are forgotten and branches are checked without deriving general post-statement facts. This policy is not a full CFG fixed-point analysis. Lambda bodies start their own environments with parameter contracts; captured locals are unknown. Fields and array elements provide no tracked value evidence.

Nested generic qualifiers, override compatibility, receiver contracts, method references and whole-program summaries are outside the implemented model.

Most importantly, JSOLV does not perform general alias mutation or method effect invalidation. If an unannotated mutator changes an object denoted by a labelled binding, the existing binding's evidence can remain. This is a real limitation: the tool should be used for disciplined immutable or snapshot-like workflows, rather than advertised as sound for arbitrary mutable Java programs.

10 ClangSOLV: a standalone C++ checking frontend

10.1 Why a frontend rather than only a template library

C++ can encode labels in template types, but that changes the types carried through APIs. A separate portable CSOLV library explores that approach. ClangSOLV instead aims for JSOLV-like use of ordinary objects, declarations, assignments and control flow, with evidence managed by a checker.

Clang LibTooling provides infrastructure for standalone compiler-based tools [8]. ClangSOLV links its AST, frontend and analysis libraries, invokes semantic parsing, and inspects resolved declarations. It is not a textual macro scanner, a compiler fork, or an AST-dumping subprocess. The executable checks source and reports errors; a native compiler separately produces the executable.

The frontend validates that Clang can construct a CFG for each checked function, but its transfer engine follows a supported structured-AST subset. It is not a general CFG-element solver and does not use Clang's general flow-sensitive framework. This distinction explains the explicit rejection of unsupported control-flow constructs.

10.2 Configuration and generated label types

```
# clangsolv.properties
namespace=example::tags
labels=Persisted, Validated, Authenticated, Approved
```

A Python generator emits a header containing empty record declarations:

```
#include <clangsolv/annotations.hpp>
namespace example::tags {
struct CLANGSOLV_ANNOTATE("clangsolv.label") Persisted {};
struct CLANGSOLV_ANNOTATE("clangsolv.label") Validated {};
// Other configured labels have the same form.
}
```

The records identify propositions; applications need not instantiate them. Macros stringify label names and the analyzer resolves them against qualified registered records. A short name is accepted only when unambiguous.

The C++ configuration deliberately implements a smaller properties-like format than Java's. Blank lines and full-line comments are supported, but Java continuation/escape semantics and inline comments are not. Unknown keys, duplicates, keywords and invalid identifiers fail generation. Similar looking config files should not be assumed to have identical parsing rules.

10.3 Readable public contracts

Syntax	Contract meaning
`returns(L...)`	Successful result establishes the listed labels
`needs(L...)`	Parameter requires every listed label
`preserves()`	Result retains all known labels of explicit argument one
`preserves(k)`	Same rule for explicit argument k, indexed from one
`readonly`	Trusted promise that the call preserves the caller's tracked evidence

Table 3: ClangSOLV's deliberately short, unprefixed contract interface.

The name `needs` leaves the C++20 `requires` keyword available. The examples and supplied helper use C++17. The contract macros expand to Clang annotation attributes during checking; non-Clang native compilation erases those annotations. The attribute spelling uses familiar C++ attribute syntax, but `clang::annotate` and its custom semantics are not a standard C++ verification feature.

The empty preservation macro argument emits an empty annotation payload; the checker interprets it as one. This keeps defaulting out of complicated preprocessor argument-count logic. Explicit invalid indices still fail. Contracts on public declarations govern calls and definitions across redeclarations. The checker does not infer implementations across translation units or prove these summaries.

11 A complete C++ application

Generate `clangsolv_labels.hpp` from the configuration above and compile the following single translation unit. Its domain behavior mirrors the Java example while making the separate effect promise visible.

```
#include <clangsolv_labels.hpp>
#include <iostream>
#include <stdexcept>
#include <string>
#include <vector>

namespace example {
struct Article { std::string title; };
std::vector<Article> store;

returns(Persisted) Article persist(Article article);
readonly returns(Validated) preserves()
Article validate(const Article& article);
readonly returns(Authenticated) preserves()
Article authenticate(const Article& article, const std::string& credential);
readonly void publish(
    needs(Persisted, Validated, Authenticated) const Article& article);

Article persist(Article article) {
    store.push_back(article);
    return article;
}
Article validate(const Article& article) {
    if (article.title.empty())
        throw std::invalid_argument("empty title");
    return article;
```

```
}
Article authenticate(const Article& article, const std::string& credential) {
    if (credential != "demo-author")
        throw std::invalid_argument("bad demo credential");
    return article;
}
void publish(const Article& article) {
    std::cout << "Published: " << article.title << '\n';
}
}

int main(int argc, char**) {
    using namespace example;
    using namespace example::tags;
    Article chosen;
    const std::string credential="demo-author";
    const auto saved=persist(Article{"One type, several facts"});
    const auto checked=validate(saved);
    const auto ready=authenticate(checked,credential);
    publish(ready);

    if (argc>1) chosen=checked;
    else chosen=saved;
    clangsolv::require<Persisted>(chosen);
    const auto checkedAgain=validate(chosen);
    const auto readyAgain=authenticate(checkedAgain,credential);
    publish(readyAgain);
}
```

Raw storage and the credential are constructed before evidence is gathered. Unknown non-trivial constructor effects can otherwise erase earlier facts. The explicit temporaries also avoid unsupported side-effecting multi-argument evaluation patterns.

The output function may truthfully be `readonly` even though it performs I/O: the contract means preserving tracked evidence, not mathematical purity. Persistence is not declared readonly. Its call erases previous evidence after checking inputs and capturing the contracted result, which can still establish fresh persistence evidence.

11.1 Rejected uses

The following statements, inserted at suitable points after their operands are declared, illustrate missing evidence:

```
publish(saved);                // missing Validated and Authenticated
publish(checked);              // missing Authenticated
// after chosen's branch join:
clangsolv::require<Validated>(chosen); // not common to both paths
```

A member write such as `chosen.title = "changed"` erases the environment. It cannot retain a stale validation fact merely because the variable keeps its name.

11.2 Explicit markers

The support library supplies runtime no-op templates:

```
clangsolv::establish<example::tags::Approved>(chosen);
clangsolv::require<example::tags::Approved>(chosen);
clangsolv::forget<example::tags::Approved>(chosen);
clangsolv::forget(chosen);
```

Establishment is an explicit trusted assertion, suitable only after a real application proof point. It unions facts on its named target. Requiring checks a subset. Forgetting removes chosen facts or all target facts; the current alias-safe policy also erases other variables' evidence before retaining any unforgotten facts on the target.

Targets must be named automatic values, supported references or smart pointers. Global storage and static local storage, unnamed expressions and raw pointers are not supported marker targets. Label template arguments must be registered label types. These templates allocate no label storage and do not validate the object at runtime. In an unoptimized build, no-op calls may still appear; the claim is no runtime label representation, not a benchmarked zero instruction cost under every compiler setting.

12 C++ effects, aliases and structured flow

12.1 Invalidation as the conservative default

After a non-readonly call, the environment is cleared. Requirements are checked and result evidence captured first. Writes, increments, compound assignments, address taking and escapes also clear evidence. A supported plain assignment can then bind fresh right-hand-side evidence on its destination. Member reads do not inherit all labels on their containing object.

Direct references initialized from a named variable share its evidence binding. More complex borrowed expressions can have independent conservative bindings; writes and unknown effects still clear them. This policy avoids pretending to have a precise points-to analysis. Its cost is rejection of some safe programs, including ones that mutate an unrelated counter.

Defaulted value copy/move operations retain evidence under a semantic-fidelity assumption. Nontrivial defaulted copies can invoke member operations, so other evidence is conservatively erased. Custom constructors do not implicitly transfer tags. Moves erase incoming evidence before transferring the captured snapshot. Dangerous reinterpretation and const-removal casts reject checking; ordinary type-changing casts do not manufacture evidence.

12.2 Loops and reachable exits

For a while/for loop with entry environment E, the header iteration has the conceptual form

$$H_{i+1} = E \sqcap \mathrm{Back}(H_i).$$

The back edge includes normal and continue paths and appropriate condition and increment effects. Break environments contribute to exits. The zero-iteration path matters for while/for; a do loop runs at least once. Supported returns and standalone throws terminate the current normal path.

Exploratory fixed-point passes suppress diagnostics; checks are emitted at the stable state. A finite safety bound rejects unexpected nonconvergence. The analysis is flow-sensitive, but not a predicate solver: it does not automatically infer a user label from an arbitrary Boolean validator or prune all branches with literal conditions.

12.3 Unsupported syntax and evaluation order

The frontend rejects switch, goto, range-for, try/catch, coroutines, lambdas, indirect calls, virtual dispatch, loop condition declarations, dangerous casts and unmodeled AST expressions.

Custom-destructor value constructions are rejected when visible. This is not complete cleanup analysis for nested library-managed objects.

C++ argument ordering needs care. Multiple side-effecting arguments, side-effecting multi-argument contract calls and certain unsequenced binary patterns are rejected rather than checked using an assumed order. Bind intermediate results first. Member-operator contracts count explicit parameters, with Clang's implicit receiver accounted for separately.

Available nondependent user functions and instantiated templates are checked; uninstantiated dependent bodies are deferred. System-header implementations are opaque boundaries. Unsupported constructs result in diagnostics rather than an implied promise of general C++ coverage.

13 Smart pointers: labels belong to the pointee

13.1 The semantic choice

For `shared_ptr<Article>` or `unique_ptr<Article>`, `Validated` should describe the managed article, not the ownership wrapper. The implementation therefore recognizes the semantic standard-library template specialization and normalizes its label domain to the pointee type. Application type aliases are recognized without relying on source spelling.

This keeps ordinary API types:

```
returns(Persisted) std::shared_ptr<Article> persistShared(Article draft);
readonly returns(Validated) preserves()
std::shared_ptr<Article> validateShared(
    const std::shared_ptr<Article>& article);
readonly void inspect(needs(Persisted, Validated) const Article& article);
```

No `tagged<Article,...>` wrapper is inserted between the angle brackets. C++ declaration attributes do not supply Java's arbitrary type-use annotation model; the pointee meaning is assigned by ClangSOLV to the declared contract.

13.2 Copies, moves and dereferencing

The following fragment is accepted with truthful producer contracts:

```
auto saved=persistShared(Article{"Managed object"});
auto checked=validateShared(saved);
auto alias=checked;
inspect(*alias);
clangsolv::require<example::tags::Validated>(alias);
```

Both dereference and arrow operations transfer known pointee evidence. A shared-pointer copy inherits the evidence known on its source at the copy. Unique-pointer moves transfer the captured evidence to the destination and erase source evidence; other facts are conservatively erased too.

```
auto owner=std::make_unique<Article>(Article{"Exclusive ownership"});
// Trusted assertion after an actual application-specific check:
clangsolv::establish<example::tags::Validated>(owner);
auto moved=std::move(owner);
clangsolv::require<example::tags::Validated>(moved); // accepted
// require<Validated>(owner) would be rejected
```

Explicit rvalue-reference casts followed by unique-pointer construction also invalidate the source; transfer is not limited to the spelling `std::move`.

13.3 Snapshot evidence instead of a heap graph

The implementation deliberately copies evidence snapshots rather than recording precise allocation identity. This makes the specification small: copies can retain current knowledge, and modeled potentially invalidating operations erase all knowledge that might be stale.

Mutation through an alias, reset, swap, assignment, get, release and unknown calls clear the environment, including evidence on copied handles and borrowed references. Smart-pointer assignment currently restores no destination facts; initialization from a producer is preferred. Forgetting also clears other bindings, covering revocation through a copied handle.

```
auto p=persistShared(Article{"Example"});
auto q=p;
q->title="replacement";
// A requirement for Persisted on *p now fails conservatively.
```

The policy can discard facts that remain true at runtime. For example, resetting one shared owner need not invalidate the article owned by another, but the checker forgets evidence rather than reasoning about that allocation. Conversely, labels established on one handle after an earlier copy do not automatically appear on that copy. Establish first and then copy, or use the explicitly labelled handle.

Preservation compares pointee domain types, ignoring outer ownership wrappers and const qualification. It promises facts on the result, not that the result aliases an input. This prevents a preservation summary from being misread as an allocation-identity proof.

13.4 Ownership and lifetime boundaries

Supported ownership is `shared_ptr<T>` and `unique_ptr<T>` with the default deleter, for an ordinary single pointee. Arrays, nested pointer pointees, custom unique deleters, raw-pointer adoption and converting ownership constructors are rejected. Use make_shared, make_unique or trusted contracted factories. Const observers such as Boolean conversion, use_count and unique preserve evidence but supply no labels.

A default or empty pointer has no evidence. A trusted establishment or return contract describing a pointee must promise that a live managed object exists and satisfies the predicates. There is no independent nullness, lifetime or borrow checker. Visible user-defined pointee destructors are rejected; contracted factories must not hide deleter effects that invalidate other tracked objects. Hidden custom shared deleters, external aliases, concurrency and complete destruction analysis remain outside this sequential model. Raw-pointer contracts remain unsupported. These restrictions are important when interpreting “supports smart pointers”: the tool supports a bounded evidence-flow discipline, not every C++ ownership operation.

14 C++ build integration and reproducible use

Building the frontend requires matching LLVM/Clang development headers, libraries and CMake exports, not only a compiler executable. The tested installation is LLVM/Clang 19.1.0 with MSVC 19.44 on Windows. LLVM/Clang 18+ is an intended API range, not a validated compatibility matrix. CMake 3.20+ and Python 3.10+ are the documented build baseline.

```
cmake -S . -B build/checker -DLLVM_DIR=/llvm/lib/cmake/llvm -DClang_DIR=/llvm/lib/
    cmake/clang
cmake --build build/checker --config Release
ctest --test-dir build/checker -C Release --output-on-failure
```

Use actual package locations. Multi-configuration builds commonly place the executable in `Release/clangsolv.exe`; single-configuration builds typically use `clangsolv`. The tool embeds

a Clang resource-header location; retain that installation or supply an appropriate override. The workspace Windows build also handles an obsolete DIA SDK path in the installed LLVM exports through local CMake dependency rebinding.

For an application, a minimal setup is:

```
cmake_minimum_required(VERSION 3.20)
project(publishing LANGUAGES CXX)
include(/path/to/clangsolv/cmake/ClangSOLV.cmake)
add_executable(publishing main.cpp)
clangsolv_enable(publishing clangsolv.properties
  CHECKER /absolute/path/to/clangsolv
  SOURCES main.cpp)
```

The helper generates the header, checks the explicitly listed translation units, and only then permits native compilation. It always checks when the target builds rather than trusting a stale success stamp. Source enumeration and matching preprocessor/include/target flags are responsibilities of the integration; arbitrary CMake target properties are not automatically inferred. Use `OPTIONS` for extra flags and `DEPENDS` for relevant headers.

ClangSOLV also accepts explicit compiler flags and compilation databases:

```
clangsolv --report report.json main.cpp -- -std=c++17 -Igenerated -I/path/to/clangsolv
    /library/include
clangsolv -p build-directory --report report.json src/main.cpp src/workflow.cpp
```

A compilation database records the working directory and actual command for each translation unit [9]. For complex builds this is preferable to reconstructing flags manually, provided Clang can parse those commands and the selected backend headers. Checking one build configuration does not certify every conditional-compilation variant.

The independent repository application can be built with

```
cmake -S example-app -B build/app -DCLANGSOLV_CHECKER=/absolute/path/to/clangsolv
cmake --build build/app --config Release
ctest --test-dir build/app -C Release --output-on-failure
```

It contains ordinary-value and smart-pointer workflows plus deliberate early-use, mutation, branch and loop failures. Native GCC or MSVC compilation alone does not check labels: the mandatory frontend gate is essential.

15 Diagnostics, reports and auditability

15.1 A common diagnostic contract

The most useful minimum diagnostic identifies the consumer, source location, required set, available set and missing set. Qualified label identities avoid confusing same-spelled labels from different vocabularies. Both tools provide compiler errors and optional machine-readable reports.

Current reports describe checks, not complete proof provenance. They do not reconstruct every earlier producer, merge and invalidation responsible for the present evidence. A future trace should distinguish trusted introduction from mechanically propagated evidence and explain the path on which a label was lost. That would make the original “trust budget” idea actionable: audit relatively few introduction points rather than every consumer.

15.2 JSOLV schema

The Java report uses schema 2 with a processor identity and a checks array:

```
{
  "schema": 2,
  "processor": "org.jsolv.checker.JsolvProcessor",
  "checks": [{
    "source": "file:///example/PaperWorkflow.java",
    "line": 42, "column": 17,
    "method": "publish", "argumentIndex": 1,
    "required": ["example.tags.Authenticated"],
    "known": [], "missing": ["example.tags.Authenticated"],
    "accepted": false
  }]
}
```

The values are illustrative schema examples, not a transcript of the numbered listings. Required-argument events are reported at the final processing round; not all expressions or diagnostics are inventoried. Invalid Java can prevent that stage. An up-to-date Maven compilation can preserve an old report if javac is skipped; use a clean compilation when freshness matters.

15.3 ClangSOLV schema

The C++ report uses schema 1 and includes overall acceptance, native compiler exit status, source files, checked-function/CFG counts, requirements and checker diagnostics. A requirement event has the following central fields:

```
{
  "consumer": "example::publish",
  "required": ["example::tags::Authenticated"],
  "known": ["example::tags::Persisted"],
  "missing": ["example::tags::Authenticated"],
  "accepted": false
}
```

Actual events also contain location fields. Clang parser diagnostics remain on stderr and are not duplicated in the custom diagnostic array, but parser failure makes overall acceptance false. Neither schema is a proof certificate for the application's domain claims. Consumers of reports should account for their different versions and failure modes.

16 What the two implementations have in common, and what they do not

Dimension	JSOLV	ClangSOLV
Source interface	Generated Java annotations	Short declaration macros and label records
Compiler integration	javac annotation processor	Standalone LibTooling executable
Vocabulary generation	Maven generate-sources	Python generator plus CMake dependency
Required facts	Multiple parameter annotations	needs on a parameter
Established result	Return/method annotations	returns on a function
Default preservation	@PreservesTags	preserves()

Dimension	JSOLV	ClangSOLV
Effect summary	No general effect model	readonly; other calls erase evidence
Assignments	Replace destination binding	Global invalidation then supported fresh destination evidence
Reachability	Limited scanner approximation	Supported normal, break and continue exits
Loops	Forget assigned bindings; no general post facts	Structured fixed point with safety bound
Aliasing	No general mutation analysis	Conservative global kills
Smart-pointer pointees	Not applicable to Java ownership templates	Bounded shared/unique pointer summaries
Separate compilation	CLASS metadata in JARs	Contract-bearing declarations in included headers
General qualifiers	Not a complete Java qualifier system	Not a complete C++ qualified-type system
Domain postcondition proofs	Trusted	Trusted

Table 4: A comparison of implemented policies rather than only surface syntax.

Java's native annotation syntax provides a particularly smooth declaration experience. C++ needs a compiler-specific annotation mechanism for the frontend, but short macros hide that spelling while leaving ordinary application types intact. ClangSOLV's effect policy is more conservative and its supported loop analysis more explicit; it also rejects a larger list of language constructs. Neither syntax alone determines overall elegance.

The deepest common design is application-owned atoms plus generic checking. The deepest difference is how much the analyzer knows about changes to an object after a fact is established. A common label algebra does not make the implementations interchangeable or equally strong on arbitrary code.

17 Trust, conditional soundness and failure modes

17.1 Where evidence enters

In the broad proposal, evidence might come from compiler-proved facts, verified callee post-conditions, recognized successful predicates, external contracts or explicit assumptions. The present tools mainly use trusted return/preservation summaries; ClangSOLV also exposes trusted establishment and effect summaries. Naming a method `validate` does not verify it.

A practical audit should ask what each label means, which operations may introduce it, which transformations preserve it, which changes destroy it, and whether the environment can change outside the analyzer's view. Domain tests and code review remain necessary at those boundaries.

17.2 A conditional property, not a whole-program theorem

For an idealized fragment, let each label ℓ denote a predicate P_ℓ. Assume all introductions and summaries are truthful, supported copies preserve those predicates, all relevant invalidations are modeled, and no invisible external or concurrent mutation occurs. Then evidence inclusion at a

consumer can correspond to the required runtime predicates on every modeled incoming path. An induction follows the producer, transfer and intersection rules.

Those assumptions are substantial. JSOLV's lack of effect/alias invalidation means this conditional argument must be restricted to stable values and disciplined workflow code. ClangSOLV's coarse kills address modeled mutations, but its unsupported syntax, trusted library effects and incomplete cleanup analysis prevent a theorem for arbitrary C++. This paper therefore does not promote the prototypes to general memory or security analyzers.

17.3 Typical false confidence

An annotation can be incorrect. A preserved label may be representation-sensitive. An authenticated state may be tied to an expired credential. An object may be changed through an external alias. A label on a parent object may say nothing about a extracted field. A copied object's custom member operation may violate the assumed predicate. A native build may bypass the checker. Each case has a different remedy; adding more label names alone solves none.

The trust model also excludes arbitrary security conclusions. In particular, `SQLSafe` is not a generic guarantee across query contexts, and absence of `Secret` does not prove that logging is permitted. The tool can enforce a documented workflow discipline; it cannot replace contextual security reasoning.

17.4 False positives and appropriate remedies

Conservative analysis may reject a valid flow. A ClangSOLV counter increment can erase unrelated article facts; a reset of one shared owner can erase another owner's still-valid evidence; JSOLV may include a branch that returns early in a subsequent merge.

Prefer immutable snapshots, smaller workflow functions, explicit evaluation order, and truthful contracted boundaries. Do not mark an arbitrary mutator readonly or establish a label merely to silence a diagnostic. A future precision improvement should retain conservative defaults and state the new reasoning rule explicitly.

18 Application areas and vocabulary design

18.1 Input processing and security workflows

Labels can distinguish parsing, validation, normalization, authentication, signature checking and output-context preparation. Context should be visible in names or domain values: `HTMLTextEscaped` and `SQLParameterBound` communicate different guarantees more effectively than one universal `Safe` label. These are examples of workflow obligations, not claims that symbolic labels solve injection or authorization by themselves.

18.2 Numerical and scientific workflows

A matrix routine can require `SymmetryChecked` and `PositiveDefinitenessChecked`; a mesh consumer can require `ManifoldChecked`. The label records an application's accepted check, including its numerical tolerance and representation assumptions. Replacing matrix entries must invalidate representation-sensitive evidence. Floating-point properties and approximate checks deserve careful domain documentation.

18.3 Financial and operational workflows

A risk publication boundary can require `Reconciled`, `GreeksCurrent` and `RiskLimitsChecked`. Those facts refer to a particular book snapshot and market-data context. Adding a trade or

changing the calibration input can invalidate them. Atomic names can encode a useful local discipline, but versioned market context is not represented automatically.

18.4 Protocol milestones and capabilities

`Parsed`, `Committed` and `SignatureVerified` may coexist as independent milestones. That differs from choosing one enumerated protocol state, although typestate can also be represented with product states. Do not interpret ordinary duplicable labels as linear authority tokens. Unique-pointer ownership transfer is modeled, but an `Approved` label is not thereby a single-use capability.

18.5 Vocabulary governance

Prefer a small documented vocabulary owned by an application or shared API. Specify successful introduction, scope, preservation and expiry conditions. Avoid vague labels whose meaning differs between teams. Generate shared labels once per Java JAR or C++ header ownership boundary, and use qualified names when ambiguity arises. Adding a name is cheap; maintaining its meaning across API changes is the real engineering responsibility.

19 Relationship to other approaches

19.1 Wrappers and phantom types

Wrappers can hide representation, restrict construction, and make contracts native type checks. Phantom-type parameters can represent state combinations without enumerating classes. The portable CSOLV implementation follows a template-oriented path and needs no special frontend, but exposes stateful wrapper types in signatures. JSOLV and ClangSOLV instead keep nominal types ordinary and make checker activation part of the build contract.

19.2 Refinement types and dependent types

A refinement type can express a predicate over a value; a dependent type can relate types to values more generally. The present labels are opaque atomic propositions with restricted transport rules. There is no arithmetic solver, quantification, predicate definition language or proof-term checking. This reduces expressiveness while keeping configuration and diagnostics approachable. Parameterized tags would move toward richer refinements and should therefore be introduced with a deliberately limited logic.

19.3 Typestate, taint and effects

Typestate connects legal operations to abstract state. Taint analysis tracks sources, transformations and sinks, often under a predefined security policy. Labels provide a general application vocabulary for similar flow obligations, but do not claim novelty over the underlying analyses. Effects describe computational changes and complement value facts; ClangSOLV's readonly summary is a minimal effect boundary rather than a full effect system.

19.4 Qualifier frameworks and abstract interpretation

The Checker Framework supplies a substantially broader platform for Java pluggable type systems and analyses [10]. JSOLV's engineering choice is a small dedicated protocol and generator, not a claim of stronger qualifier coverage. Abstract interpretation provides the conceptual foundation for finite evidence domains and fixed-point approximation [11]. The contribution here is exposing selected domain atoms and build-time obligations through a compact application-owned interface.

20 Regression evidence and evaluation limits

The current Java regression suite passes 24 tests: three generator, four original persistence-checker, and seventeen configurable-label tests. They cover generation validation and ownership, nested calls, assignment and joins, preservation, qualified identities, reports and separate compilation. These tests were rerun for this manuscript on JDK 17.0.12 and Maven 3.9.11. They are regression evidence, not a performance or field-defect study.

The current ClangSOLV suite contains 81 end-to-end regression tests. It invokes the real LibTooling executable on generated C++ sources and checks acceptance, diagnostics and JSON. Coverage includes vocabulary errors, branch joins, loop changes, moves, unsupported expressions, implicit receiver indexing, compilation databases, default preservation and smart-pointer operations. Smart-pointer cases check accepted copies/dereferences and rejected stale evidence after mutation, reset, escape, revocation and moves from the source.

The independent C++ application has accepted runtime workflows and four intentional rejection examples. Its ordinary and smart-pointer sources were checked with LLVM/Clang 19.1.0 and built/run with native MSVC 19.44 and GCC 13.3.0 in the workspace. Cross-backend compilation shows ordinary application representation; it does not make the verification mechanism standard C++.

No large-corpus benchmark, annotation-density measurement, user study, compile-time overhead result or quantified defect reduction is claimed. Regression success establishes selected behavior, not mathematical soundness or practical superiority. Representative mutation counterexamples and unsupported feature tests are as important as accepted demonstration pipelines.

21 Adoption in an existing application

Begin with a small number of high-value consumer requirements, such as a publication or submission boundary. Document their meaning and annotate existing successful producer operations. Generate a vocabulary in an application-owned package or namespace and activate checking in every relevant build configuration.

Inspect missing-evidence diagnostics as design questions. Was a stage genuinely skipped? Does the transformation preserve the claimed fact? Is the value immutable enough for the analyzer's assumptions? Is the code pattern outside the supported fragment? Distinguishing these cases avoids turning labels into decorative assertions.

Keep configuration and handwritten sources in version control. Treat generated sources, headers and compiler output as build artifacts. For Java, clean after label removal or renaming to eliminate stale classes. For C++, make all relevant translation units and their includes available to the check and align flags with native compilation. Reports should record the build context sufficiently for reviewers to identify what was actually analyzed.

Tests remain responsible for producer semantics; review remains responsible for trusted summaries. Incremental adoption can concentrate those obligations at a few boundaries while allowing automatic propagation through ordinary workflow code.

22 A research agenda grounded in the implementations

22.1 Negative knowledge

The general proposal distinguishes present, absent and unknown facts. A future extension could maintain (P^+, P^-) with disjoint sets and intersect each independently at joins. Failure to establish `Authenticated` must never imply established `NotAuthenticated`. Contradictions,

unreachable states, introduction and revocation need explicit rules before negative requirements are exposed.

22.2 Contextual labels and implication

`AuthorisedFor(resource)` and `EscapedFor(context)` can express relationships missing from a Boolean atom. A first extension might compare symbolic parameters by equality rather than invoke unrestricted logic. Finite implication rules could derive `IntegrityChecked` from `SignatureVerified`; their scope, consistency and evolution need application governance. Neither feature should be silently inferred from names.

22.3 Verified producers and predicate refinement

A recognized Boolean validator could establish a label on its true branch. A verified postcondition could reduce reliance on trusted returns. These require explicit normal/exceptional semantics and a method for connecting opaque label meaning to code. Full proof-producing validators are an optional research direction rather than a prerequisite for the current interface.

22.4 Precision in effects and heap state

Region-sensitive kills could retain facts on unrelated objects. A heap graph or memory-version model could propagate later establishment across known shared aliases and distinguish resetting a handle from mutating its pointee. Ownership can help, but unique ownership alone does not prove that an object has no outstanding borrowed reference. Destructors, custom deleters, callbacks, weak pointers and escape require their own summaries.

Such extensions should be justified by measured false positives. The present snapshot model remains attractive when simple global forgetting is sufficient; adding hidden alias inference solely for aesthetic completeness would make the specification harder to trust.

22.5 Control flow, provenance and concurrency

A general CFG solver can expand exception, switch and nonlocal-flow coverage. Provenance graphs can show where each fact entered, which assumptions it depends on and where it was lost. Scoped facts could represent lock or transaction regions, but asynchronous and concurrent changes require integration with immutability, ownership or race-freedom guarantees. A `LockHeld` atom alone cannot prove race freedom.

22.6 Empirical questions

A substantive evaluation should measure annotation density, rejection causes, build overhead and behavior under API evolution, compare equivalent wrapper designs and established analyzers, and study diagnostic comprehension. Security/input, protocol and numerical/financial examples offer different stress cases. The most valuable result may be a clear boundary identifying where small atomic contracts are sufficient and where richer verification is necessary.

23 Conclusion

Separating ordinary types from static knowledge gives application programmers a compact way to state semantic prerequisites without manufacturing a new nominal type for every workflow stage. The semantic-category argument supplies the motivation: declarations should reveal useful intent. The property-tag proposal supplies the analysis vocabulary: introduce, transport, invalidate and require facts about current values. JSOLV and ClangSOLV demonstrate two concrete realizations using mainstream build and compiler mechanisms.

Their shared strengths are configurable vocabularies, ordinary domain representation, independent facts and preservation that composes without enumerating combinations. Their differences are equally consequential: Java annotation ergonomics and restricted effect reasoning versus a C++ frontend with explicit conservative invalidation, structured loops and bounded smart-pointer pointee support. A comprehensive account must retain those differences rather than imply a universal verifier behind similar syntax.

The resulting system is best understood as an application-owned evidence-flow discipline. It makes selected workflow obligations visible, rejects supported uses lacking evidence, and concentrates trust at explicit producer and effect boundaries. Richer logical properties, precise heap reasoning and verified proof sources remain a research program built on that deliberately small core.

A Repository map and document provenance

Path below development_tools	Contents
`static_tags/semantic_roles_beyond_class.tex`	Original semantic-category ideation
`static_tags/static_property_tags.tex`	Original general property-tag proposal
`static_tags/jsolv.tex`	Java implementation paper
`static_tags/clangsolv.tex`	C++ frontend implementation paper
`static_tags/static_object_labelling.tex`	This self-contained synthesis
`jsolv/annotations`	Shared marker and preservation annotations
`jsolv/checker`	Generic javac processor
`jsolv/generator`	Maven vocabulary generator
`jsolv-app`	Independent Java application
`clangsolv/checker`	Standalone LibTooling engine
`clangsolv/library/include/clangsolv`	Contract macros and proof markers
`clangsolv/generator`	Configurable label-header generator
`clangsolv/cmake`	Mandatory-check build integration
`clangsolv/tests`	End-to-end regression suite
`clangsolv-app/src/smart_pointers.cpp`	Managed-object evidence showcase

The map records the original jmtools artifact organization. In this standalone ClangSOLV repository, the checker modules live at the root, the consumer lives in example-app, and manuscripts live in docs/papers. Java implementation paths refer to companion artifacts outside this repository. Paths identify the artifact layout rather than requiring an absolute machine directory. Existing source papers remain independent documents. This synthesis restates their ideas, updates C++ syntax to needs and default preserves(), and incorporates the current smart-pointer policy. Future changes should update claims against source and tests, not only rename examples.

B Compact contract-writing checklist

For each label, specify its predicate in application language and the value or snapshot to which it applies. For each producer, state what a successful return establishes. For each preservation promise, ensure all possible incoming labels truly remain valid. For each consumer, require exactly its prerequisites. For each mutation or ownership operation, check how evidence is

invalidated. Finally, ensure the checker actually runs with the source configuration used by the native build. This is a review aid, not an additional runtime protocol.

References

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